

GP-49-HI
MAR 1944

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GP-49-HI
MAR, 1944

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DECLASSIFIED
DOD DIR 5200.9

49th Fighter Group
Mar 1944

RM-58-4491

~~SECRET~~

GP-579-III

MAR. 1944

DESIGNATION SHEET

(Official designation, including number, of
unit and of each echelon in chain of command)

FAR EAST AIR FORCES (P)

AIR FORCE: FIFTH AIR FORCE
COMMAND: V FIGHTER COMMAND
WING: _____
GROUP: 49th FIGHTER GROUP
SQUADRON: _____

AREA: _____
BATTALION: _____
CENTER: _____
COMPANY: _____
DEPOT: _____
DETACHMENT: _____
DISTRICT: _____
DIVISION: _____
PLATOON: _____
REGIMENT: _____
REGION: _____
SCHOOL: _____
SECTION: _____
UNIT: _____
ETC.: _____

P.R.C.

Has Security Classification of material been
checked? NOT CHECKED BY FIFTH AIR FORCE

DECLASSIFIED
DOD DIR 5200.9

1316-1

RM-58- 4491

5086-4
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SECRET

HEADQUARTERS 49TH FIGHTER GROUP
ARMY AIR FORCES
APO 565

27 May, 1944.

GROUP HISTORICAL RECORD (MARCH 1944)

TO : Commanding General, Fifth Air Force, APO 925.

1. The month of March resulted in two outstanding achievements for the 49th Fighter Group:

a. The dive bombing of the 7th and 8th Squadron's P-40's proved highly successful. The pinpoint bombing of very small targets was very accurate and future use of the P-40 as a dive bomber promises a new type action for the pilots and many headaches for the Japs. A particularly interesting mission was the interruption of a morale lecture being delivered at Aitape Township by a high ranking Japanese official. This chance to personally participate in such an affair was highly pleasing to the Group and no doubt had effect on the Jap morale.

b. The 8th Fighter Squadron spent much time "burning the midnite oil" (plus some GI oil) working up a special type of cocktail for the Nips. This highly inflammable drink consisted of a blend of high octane gas and oil mixed in a P-40 belly tank. Delivered via air this incendiary tank proved its practicability enough that the future use in giving the Sons of Heaven a "Hot Time" is anticipated.

2. Routine escort and strafing missions also kept the 49th fighters busy during March over Madang-Alexishafen Area also Tadjil and Hansa Bay where enemy shipping felt the impact of .50 cal. ammo.

3. All work and no play, however, is not the policy of the 49th so that the opening of the first and only covered theater gave the men relaxation without precipitation.

4. Our air strip received a visit by five or six Jap Tony fighters. The combination of ack-ack and friendly planes returning from a mission, however made the Nips realize that they were not quite prepared to die for the Emperor. Two enemy craft were knocked down, one by a P-47 and one by ack-ack.

Robert J. Boniece
ROBERT J. BONIECE,
1st Lt., Air Corps,
Historical Officer.

SECRET

HEADQUARTERS 49TH FIGHTER GROUP
ARMY AIR FORCES
APO 565

27 May, 1944.

GROUP HISTORICAL RECORDS (MARCH 1944)

TO : Commanding General, Fifth Air Force, APO 925.

1. Strength.

a. Personnel, commissioned and enlisted.

	<u>OFFICERS</u>		<u>ENLISTED MEN</u>
	<u>FLYING</u>	<u>GROUND</u>	
<u>1.</u> At beginning of period	4	16	56
<u>2.</u> Net increase during period	0	1	4
<u>3.</u> Net decrease during period	0	0	0
<u>4.</u> At end of period	4	17	60

2. Aircraft --- None with unit.

3. Ground battles engaged in by unit --- Nil.

Robert J Boniece
ROBERT J. BONIECE,
1st Lt., Air Corps,
Historical Officer.

NO.	NAME	GRADE	DATE	REMARKS
DB	...	A	...	...
A	...	I	...	...
O	...	O	...	...
CO	...	A	...	...

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DOD DIR 5200.9